

Research Report

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

Gordon Wright

22 February 2026

Key Information

Deadline	Friday 1 April 2026, 12 noon
Submission	Via Moodle submission link
Word count	2,500 words ($\pm 10\%$)
Format	Individual lab report in APA format
Weight	40%

Task

Write an individual research report based on your group project data.

! Individual Responsibility

While data comes from your group project, the Research Report is an **individual** assessment. Each group member writes their own report independently.

Report Structure

Your report should follow standard APA format:

Section	Content
Title Page	Informative title, your name and student number
Abstract	~150 words summarising the study
Introduction	Background, rationale, hypothesis
Method	Design, Participants, Materials, Procedure

Section	Content
Results	Descriptives, inferential tests, effect sizes
Discussion	Interpretation, limitations, future directions
References	APA format

Statistical Reporting

Report results in APA format:

- **t-test:** $t(df) = X.XX, p = .XXX, d = X.XX$
 - **Correlation:** $r(df) = .XX, p = .XXX$
 - Include 95% confidence intervals
-

Report Writing Support

We build report-writing skills progressively throughout the term:

Weeks	Focus
12-15	Results section (descriptives, CIs, test results)
16-17	Methods & Introduction
18-19	Introduction continued
20	Discussion section

Project Timeline

Week	Milestone
11	Form groups (3-4 students)
12-15	Develop research question and design
—	<i>Reading Week</i> — Work on Research Plan
16	Research Plan due; Begin data collection
17-18	Data collection and initial analysis
19-20	Complete analysis; Develop write-up (term ends Week 20)
Easter	Individual report writing
Post-term	Research Report due Friday 1 April

i Post-Term Deadline

The Research Report deadline (1 April 2026) is after teaching ends. Use the Easter break to complete your write-up based on skills developed during term.

Assessment Criteria

Your report will be assessed on:

- Clarity and structure of writing
- Appropriate use of APA format
- Quality of statistical reporting
- Interpretation and discussion of findings
- Critical evaluation and suggestions for future research